TALION

Ranger of Gondor · the Gravewalker · bound to the wraith of Celebrimbor

Celebrimbor
THE WRAITH WITHIN

Level 20 **Classes** Ranger (Wraith-Bound) 17 · Fighter (Battle Master) 3 **Species** Human (Gondor) **Background** Ranger of Gondor

Alignment Neutral Good **XP** 355,000

D&D 5e (2024 PHB). His subclass (Wraith-Bound), the Might bar, Brand, Banished from Death and his three weapons are HOMEBREW (pages 2–3), built from the Ranger's own pieces. Version: *Shadow of War* (2017), Act 3: the New Ring, an orc army, Elven Rage. Talion the Nazgûl is on page 6.

STRENGTH	DEXTERITY	CONSTITUTION	INTELLIGENCE	WISDOM	CHARISMA
12	20	16	10	15	8
+1	+5	+3	+0	+2	−1
12	15 · +2 bg · +3 ASI	14 · +1 feat · +1 ASI	10	13 · +1 bg · +1 feat	8 · few words, grim

ARMOR CLASS	HIT POINTS	SPEED	MIGHT	INITIATIVE	PROFICIENCY	PASSIVE PERC.
17	224	40 ft	6	+11	+6	24
ranger's leathers	can't stay dead	climb, swim 40 ft	boxes · page 2	Alert	level 20	wraith world: 29

Defenses. Freeflow Counter HB: when a melee attack hits him, his Reaction turns it into a miss and he strikes back; each further counter that round costs a superiority die. Critical hits can't be countered. **Riposte** answers a miss (+1d8). **Evasive Footwork:** +1d8 AC while he vaults. **Saves:** Str, Dex, Con. **Last Chance:** at 0 HP, a DC 10 Con save (+9; the DC rises 5 each use) leaves him at 1 HP. **Banished from Death:** if he dies anyway, he comes back. **Nature's Veil** (2 a day): Invisible until his next turn ends. **Tough:** +40 HP.

SKILLS

● Acrobatics Dex	+11	○ Medicine Wis	+2
○ Animal Handling Wis	+2	○ Nature Int	+0
○ Arcana Int	+0	◉ Perception Wis	+14*
● Athletics Str	+7	○ Performance Cha	−1
○ Deception Cha	−1	○ Persuasion Cha	−1
○ History Int	+0	○ Religion Int	+0
● Insight Wis	+8	○ Sleight of Hand Dex	+5
● Intimidation Cha	+5	◉ Stealth Dex	+17
○ Investigation Int	+0	◉ Survival Wis	+14*

● proficient ◉ expertise. *Advantage in the wraith world (page 2).

RESOURCES

Might ☐☐☐☐☐☐	6
Elf-shot (Azkâr)	8 / short
Hunter's Mark, free	6 / long
Spell slots	4 · 3 · 3 · 3 · 1
Superiority dice (d8)	4 / short
Second Wind (1d10 + 3)	2 / long
Action Surge	1 / short
Nature's Veil	2 / long
Hit Dice	20d10

SAVING THROWS

● Strength	+7	○ Intelligence	+0
● Dexterity	+11	○ Wisdom	+2
● Constitution	+9	○ Charisma	−1

PROFICIENCIES

Armor: light, medium, shields. He wears his ranger's leathers (studded leather).

Weapons: Simple and Martial.

Tools: Herbalism Kit (the herbs of Mordor), Smith's Tools (Celebrimbor's craft).

Languages: Common (Westron), Elvish (Celebrimbor's tongue), Orc (Black Speech).

Mastery: Longsword · Sap · Longbow · Slow · Dagger · Nick

Maneuvers: Riposte · Evasive Footwork · Menacing Attack

ATTACKS

ATTACK	HIT / DC	DAMAGE	NOTES
Urfael HB	+13	1d8+9 slashing	His broken sword: +2 longsword, Finesse, Sap; Dueling included. Three per Attack action.
Acharn HB	+13	1d4+7 piercing	+2 dagger, thrown 20/60, Nick. Stealth kill: a hit on an unaware foe is a critical hit.
Azkâr: Elf-shot HB	+15	1d8+7 radiant	The wraith bow, 150/600, Slow. Focus: Advantage if he hasn't moved this turn.
Hunter's Mark	—	+1d6 force	Bonus Action, free 6 a day. Advantage against the marked foe; damage can't break it.
Shadow Strike HB	+13	per weapon	Bonus Action after an Elf-shot hit: he teleports beside the target and strikes once.
Execution HB	+13	crit, +6d8	3 Might, replaces a melee attack. A foe left at 30 HP or fewer drops to 0, bosses too.
Wraith Flash HB	DC 16 Con	3d8 radiant	2 Might, replaces an attack: foes within 10 ft are Stunned until his next turn.
Freeflow Counter HB	+13	per weapon	Reaction when a melee attack hits him: it misses, and he strikes back. +1 Might.
Riposte	+13	+1d8	Reaction, 1 superiority die: when a melee attack misses him, he strikes back.
Steel Wind Strike	+8 spell	6d10 force	5th level: a chain of Shadow Strikes through up to five foes within 30 ft.
Brand HB	DC 16 Wis	Branded	Action, orcs and beasts only: a beaten one becomes his follower (page 2).

Bonus Action: Hunter's Mark, Shadow Strike, Combat Drain, Second Wind, Nature's Veil or Elven Rage. **Spells** are Celebrimbor's powers (page 3): save DC 16, spell attack +8. **Might** fills with every hit and counter (page 2). **Celebrimbor's Strike** HB gives him a third attack.

THE WRAITH OF CELEBRIMBOR

His subclass, Wraith-Bound, all HOMEBREW: two souls in one body, and the Might they share

In the game, the Black Hand of Sauron kills Talion and his family at the Black Gate, in a ritual meant to call back an elven wraith. The wraith, Celebrimbor, the smith who forged the Rings of Power, binds to Talion instead, and Talion is banished from death. Together they fight with a ranger's skill and a wraith's power. In a fight, a streak of hits and counters builds Might for executions and wraith powers. **On this sheet** Wraith-Bound is his Ranger subclass, and Might is a six-box bar.

The Might Bar

Six boxes (his Proficiency Bonus): the game's hit streak

Filling. +1 box each time he hits with a weapon attack, and +1 for each counter, with no limit per turn. During Elven Rage the bar doesn't fill.

Breaking the streak. He loses 1 box each time an attack hits him. The bar empties when the fight ends.

Spending. The techniques on the right cost boxes. Elven Rage takes a full bar.

Freeflow Counter HB Ranger 3. When a creature he can see hits him with a melee attack, his Reaction counters it: the hit becomes a miss, and he makes one melee attack against the attacker. Once his Reaction is spent, each further counter that round costs a superiority die. A critical hit can't be countered (the game's red, unblockable attacks). Riposte still answers attacks that miss.

Bar: ☐☐☐☐☐☐

A Might fight. Round 1: Hunter's Mark and three hits (3 boxes). His foe's turn: one blow countered (4), one lands (3). Round 2: three hits (6). Round 3: Elven Rage, three Executions, about 150 damage.

MIGHT TECHNIQUES

	TECHNIQUE	EFFECT (SAVE DC 16)
3	**Execution** Ranger 3 · 3 boxes	Replaces a melee attack. A hit is a critical hit with 3d8 extra damage (6d8 on the crit). A creature left at 30 HP or fewer drops to 0 HP, captains and bosses included, with no save. Relentless Rage and the like still work.
2	**Wraith Flash** Ranger 7 · 2 boxes	Replaces an attack. Each foe he chooses within 10 ft makes a Con save: 3d8 radiant and Stunned until the start of his next turn, or half damage on a success.
2	**Combat Drain** Ranger 7 · 2 boxes	Bonus Action, a creature within 5 ft that's Stunned, Grappled or Prone: it takes 2d8 necrotic, he regains 2d8 + 2 HP and 3 Elf-shot, and he learns one thing it knows.
2	**Brutalize** Ranger 11 · 2 boxes	Replaces a melee attack: +3d8 damage. If it kills, foes within 30 ft who see it make a Wis save or are Frightened of him for 1 minute (a save at the end of each of their turns).
6	**Elven Rage** Ranger 15 · full bar	Bonus Action. Until the end of his next turn: Resistance to all damage, Advantage on attacks, every melee hit is a free Execution, and Shadow Strike needs no arrow (any foe he can see within 60 ft).

WRAITH POWERS

Banished from Death Ranger 3 — when he dies, his body fades. At the next nightfall he wakes at the nearest safe place, at full HP, with his gear. The orc who killed him is promoted (Nemesis, below).

The Wraith World Ranger 3 — Bonus Action, 1 minute. He sees as Celebrimbor does: tracks and trails glow, foes within 60 ft show through walls, and invisible creatures within 30 ft are plain to him. Advantage on Perception and Survival checks that use sight.

Shadow Strike Ranger 3 — Bonus Action after he hits with Elf-shot: he teleports to a space next to the target and makes one melee attack.

Celebrimbor's Strike HB Ranger 3 · two souls, one body — when he takes the Attack action, the wraith makes one extra attack with him (Urfael or Elf-shot): three attacks per Attack action.

Last Chance Ranger 7 — when he drops to 0 HP and doesn't die outright, a DC 10 Con save (+9) leaves him at 1 HP instead. Each use since his last long rest adds 5 to the DC.

BRAND AND THE ARMY

Brand Ranger 7 — Action. He seizes a creature within 5 ft: an orc, uruk, olog or beast that is Stunned, Grappled, Prone or at half its HP or less. It makes a DC 16 Wis save. On a failure it's **Branded**: Charmed by him for good, it obeys his orders and fights for him. If he or his allies harm it, it saves again. Named captains save with Advantage.

The New Ring Ranger 11 — Celebrimbor's new Ring of Power. Captains and warchiefs lose that Advantage. A branded captain can be called as a bodyguard, arriving at the start of his next turn (once per short rest).

Shadow Mount Ranger 7 — branded beasts (caragors, graugs, drakes) can be ridden. In a fight, *Dominate Beast* does it fast.

Men, elves and dwarves can't be branded. In the game the brand works on orcs and Mordor's beasts.

THE NEMESIS SYSTEM

In the game, every orc captain has a name, a rank, strengths, weaknesses and a memory of Talion. An orc who kills him is promoted. One he scars comes back with the scar and a grudge. Learning a captain's weakness (from Drain, or a branded spy) is how he beats the strong ones.

On this sheet: a named orc who kills Talion gains a rank: +10 HP, +1 to hit, and one new strength. When Talion knows a captain's weakness (fire, beasts, stealth, a fear), his attacks that use it have Advantage.

Grunt | Captain | Bodyguard | Warchief | Overlord

PLAYING IT

Against one foe, Brand and the army don't matter: counters, Hunter's Mark and the Might bar do. Mark first, then counter every blow: each counter turns a hit into a miss and feeds the bar. Bank a full bar for Elven Rage (three Executions, about 150 damage), and spend a single Execution only to finish a foe at 30 HP or fewer. Last Chance (+9) keeps him up once or twice; Banished from Death only means the loss isn't forever.

URFAEL · ACHARN · AZKÂR

His weapons, the New Ring, his freeflow and Celebrimbor's powers, HOMEBREW where the PHB has nothing close

Urfael

His broken sword · +2 longsword

The Gondorian sword he carried at the Black Gate, broken the night he died. 1d8 slashing (1d10 two-handed), mastery Sap. The broken blade is short and quick, so it has Finesse. With Dueling: +13, 1d8 + 9. In the game, runes (*Mordor*) and gems (*War*) are set in it; here they're the +2.

Acharn

His dagger · +2 dagger

The blade for quiet kills and executions. 1d4 piercing, Finesse, Light, thrown 20/60, Nick: +13, 1d4 + 7. **Stealth kill:** a hit on a creature that hasn't noticed him is a critical hit. **Death from above:** after dropping 10 ft or more onto a foe, a hit is a critical hit.

Azkâr

Celebrimbor's wraith bow · +2 longbow

A bow of wraith light that makes its own arrows. 1d8 radiant, range 150/600, Slow. With Archery: +15, 1d8 + 7. **Elf-shot:** 8 shots, back on a short rest; Combat Drain returns 3. **Focus:** if he hasn't moved this turn, his Elf-shots have Advantage (the game slows time as he aims). A hit opens Shadow Strike.

The New Ring

Celebrimbor's new Ring of Power · requires attunement

Forged at the start of *Shadow of War*, free of Sauron's taint. It powers the Brand at its strongest: captains and warchiefs save without Advantage, and a branded captain comes as a bodyguard when he calls. Shelob takes it early on, and he has to bargain it back.

Freeflow

Strike, counter, vault, stun · Battle Master: 4d8 superiority dice, DC 19

Freeflow Counter HB is the counter: his Reaction turns a melee hit into a miss and strikes back, and each further counter that round costs a superiority die (never against a critical hit). **Riposte** answers a miss (+1d8). **Evasive Footwork** is the vault and roll: +1d8 AC while he moves. **Menacing Attack:** +1d8, and a Wis save or Frightened until the end of his next turn. **The stun:** a Shove knocks a foe Prone (DC 15).

Mounts

Branded or dominated beasts · sketches

Caragor: Large, AC 13, 45 HP, Speed 50 ft, bite +6, 2d8 + 4. **Graug:** Huge, AC 15, 150 HP, Speed 40 ft, slam +9, 3d10 + 6. **Drake** (*War*): Huge, AC 17, 180 HP, fly 80 ft, fire breath in a 60-ft cone, DC 16 Dex, 10d6. Mounted Combatant keeps them alive.

CELEBRIMBOR'S POWERS his Ranger spells, cast with Wisdom, shining with the wraith's pale light

LVL	SPELL	AS THE WRAITH
1	**Hunter's Mark**	Celebrimbor marks the prey. Free 6 times a day; Advantage against it (Precise Hunter).
1	**Jump · Detect Magic**	The huge leaps and drops; the wraith world shows ring-craft and Morgul sorcery.
2	**Pass without Trace · Darkvision**	A ranger in the wraith's shadow; seeing in the dark of Mordor.
2	**Locate Object · Locate Animals or Plants**	Finding Celebrimbor's lost artifacts; herbs and beasts for the hunt.
3	**Daylight**	Elven light that breaks the shadow.
3	**Lightning Arrow · Conjure Barrage**	An Elf-shot that bursts in wraith light (radiant, not lightning); a fan of Elf-shot.
4	**Dominate Beast**	Shadow Mount: a caragor, graug or drake takes him on its back.
4	**Locate Creature · Freedom of Movement**	The wraith hunts a captain by name; nothing holds a man banished from death.
5	**Steel Wind Strike**	Shadow Strikes chained through up to five foes: 6d10 force each.
5	**Swift Quiver**	Elf-shot as fast as he can draw: two more shots each turn (Concentration, so not with Hunter's Mark).

FIGHTING AS TALION

Round one: Alert puts him first. Hunter's Mark as a Bonus Action, then three Urfael hits with Advantage (Celebrimbor's Strike, Precise Hunter): about 50 damage, and 3 Might.

At range: three Elf-shots with Focus, then Shadow Strike onto the target for a fourth blow.

A crowd: Wraith Flash to stun the ring around him, Executions on the stunned, Steel Wind Strike for the rest. Brutalize breaks their nerve.

A boss: counter every blow, Riposte every miss, bank six boxes, then Elven Rage: three Executions, about 150 damage. A single Execution finishes anything left at 30 HP or fewer.

STEALTH AND THE HUNT

Stealth +17 (Expertise), +10 more under Pass without Trace. Nature's Veil makes him Invisible until the end of his next turn. The wraith world shows every guard through the walls, and from hiding Acharn's first hit is a critical.

Survival +14 and Perception +14 (Expertise), Advantage in the wraith world. Torvin taught him beasts; Locate Animals or Plants and the Herbalism Kit find food and healing herbs anywhere in Mordor.

CLASS FEATURES · the blue note is what each one stands for in the story

Ranger 17 (2024 PHB) — the Ranger of Gondor

Spellcasting R1 · Celebrimbor's powers — Wisdom, save DC 16, spell attack +8. Slots 4/3/3/3/1; 14 spells prepared plus Hunter's Mark (page 3).

Favored Enemy R1 · the orcs of Mordor — Hunter's Mark always prepared; he casts it free 6 times per long rest.

Weapon Mastery R1 — Longsword (Sap) and Longbow (Slow); the Fighter levels add Dagger (Nick).

Deft Explorer R2 · years on the Gate — Expertise in Stealth; Elvish and Orc.

Fighting Style: Dueling R2 · sword in one hand — +2 damage with a one-handed melee weapon. His free hand drains and brands.

Extra Attack R5 — two attacks per Attack action; three with Celebrimbor's Strike.

Roving R6 · Mordor's towers — +10 ft Speed; Climb and Swim Speed equal to it.

Expertise R9 · the wraith's eyes — Perception and Survival.

Tireless R10 — Magic action: 1d8 + 2 temporary HP, 6 times per long rest; a short rest removes 1 Exhaustion.

Relentless Hunter R13 — taking damage can't break his Concentration on Hunter's Mark.

Nature's Veil R14 · the wraith's shadow — Bonus Action: Invisible until the end of his next turn, twice per long rest.

Precise Hunter R17 — Advantage on attacks against the creature he has marked.

Wraith-Bound HOMEBREW — his subclass (page 2)

The Ritual R3 · the night at the Black Gate — Banished from Death, the wraith world, Azkâr and Elf-shot, Shadow Strike, Freeflow Counter, Celebrimbor's Strike (a third attack), the Might bar and Execution.

The Gravewalker R7 · Udûn — Brand, Shadow Mount, Wraith Flash, Combat Drain, Last Chance.

The New Ring R11 · *Shadow of War* — branded captains and bodyguards; Brutalize.

Elven Rage R15 · the Bright Lord's war — a full Might bar unleashed.

Fighter 3 (Battle Master) — the freeflow

Fighting Style: Archery F1 — +2 to ranged attack rolls.

Second Wind F1 — Bonus Action: 1d10 + 3 HP, twice per long rest. **Action Surge**, **Tactical Mind** (F2).

Combat Superiority F3 · counter, vault — 4d8 superiority dice, DC 19: Riposte, Evasive Footwork, Menacing Attack; the dice also pay for extra Freeflow Counters. Student of War: Insight, Smith's Tools.

FEATS (4) AND ABILITY SCORE IMPROVEMENTS (2)

Alert background · the Black Gate watch — adds Proficiency Bonus to Initiative; can swap Initiative with an ally.

Tough Human · a soldier's body — +2 HP per level (+40).

Resilient (Con) R4 · a body that won't quit — +1 Con; proficiency in Constitution saving throws (+9).

Ability Score Improvements R8, R12 — +2 Dex; +1 Dex, +1 Con.

Mounted Combatant R16 · caragors, graugs, drakes — +1 Wis; Advantage on attacks against smaller foes on foot next to his mount; it takes no damage on a successful Dex save, half on a fail; he can take a hit meant for it.

Origin. Human: Resourceful (Heroic Inspiration each long rest), Skillful (Intimidation), Versatile (Tough). **Ranger of Gondor** (custom background, built like the PHB ones): +2 Dex, +1 Wis; Alert; Acrobatics and Athletics; Herbalism Kit.

GEAR

Weapons — Urfael, Acharn and Azkâr (page 3), each +2.

The New Ring — Celebrimbor's Ring of Power, worn on the hand that brands.

Ranger's leathers — studded leather (AC 17), a hooded cloak, bracers. In *War*, sets of armor and cloaks taken from captains.

Herbalism Kit — Mordor's healing herbs.

TWO MINDS

Celebrimbor rides in Talion's body and talks in his head: the elf wants Sauron's fall, then more; the man wants his family's killers dead, then rest. HB **Two minds:** once per long rest, when Talion fails a save against being Charmed or Frightened, Celebrimbor's will lets him reroll it. And once per long rest Talion can ask the wraith one question about the Second Age, the Rings or Sauron, and get a true answer, if a self-serving one.

HIS ARMY bodyguards the New Ring can call · HOMEBREW sketches

FOLLOWER	NUMBERS	NOTES
Branded uruk captain	Medium, AC 16, 85 HP, Speed 30 ft	Two scimitar attacks, +7, 2d6 + 4. A named strength and a weakness of the DM's choice.
Branded olog-hai	Large, AC 17, 150 HP, Speed 40 ft	Two club attacks, +9, 3d8 + 5. Ologs from *War* shrug off fear.
Branded warchief	Medium, AC 18, 130 HP, Speed 30 ft	Three attacks, +8, 2d8 + 5; one Legendary Resistance. Brings two grunts.

One comes when he calls (The New Ring, once per short rest). In a sim, a bodyguard acts right after Talion on the Initiative count.

LEVEL BY LEVEL — FOLLOWING THE STORY

LVL	GAINS	WHERE HE IS IN THE STORY
1	Ranger 1: spells, Favored Enemy · Alert, Tough	A Ranger of Gondor. He marries Ioreth; their son is Dirhael.
2	Fighter 1: Archery, Second Wind	Posted to the Black Gate, where Gondor keeps watch on Mordor.
3	Action Surge, Tactical Mind	Years on the Gate. He rises to lead its Rangers.
4	Battle Master: Riposte, Evasive Footwork, Menacing Attack	He teaches Dirhael the sword.
5	Deft Explorer, Dueling	Quiet years. Mordor is empty, and the Gate's watch grows thin.
6	The Ritual: Banished from Death, Azkâr, Shadow Strike, Freeflow Counter, Celebrimbor's Strike, Might	**Shadow of Mordor:** the Black Hand, the Hammer and the Tower take the Gate. Talion and his family die in a ritual; Celebrimbor's wraith binds to him.
7	Resilient (Con)	Udûn: he climbs the forge towers and meets Gollum, who knows the wraith.
8	Extra Attack	Hirgon and the deserters; Ratbag, a cowardly orc who wants to climb the ranks.
9	Roving	He hunts captains and learns Mordor's ways: kill, scar, promote.
10	The Gravewalker: Brand, Wraith Flash, Combat Drain, Last Chance	Celebrimbor remembers the brand, and orcs start to serve him. The Hammer falls.
11	Ability Score Improvement (+2 Dex)	Nurn: Queen Marwen and Lithariel; Torvin the dwarf teaches him to hunt beasts.
12	Expertise, 3rd-level spells	Branded warchiefs. The Tower and the Black Hand die. Celebrimbor decides to forge a new ring.
13	Tireless	**Shadow of War:** the New Ring is forged. Shelob takes it, and he bargains it back.
14	The New Ring, Brutalize	Minas Ithil falls to the Nazgûl. He starts building an orc army.
15	Ability Score Improvement (+1 Dex, +1 Con)	Fortress by fortress: Cirith Ungol, Gorgoroth, Seregost, Nurn.
16	Relentless Hunter, 4th-level spells	He faces a Balrog.
17	Nature's Veil	Eltariel, Galadriel's blade, hunts the Nine beside him. He defeats the Nazgûl who was Isildur.
18	Elven Rage	Celebrimbor's real aim shows: to take Sauron's place as the Bright Lord.
19	Mounted Combatant	Drakes, graugs and caragors fight in his army.
20	Precise Hunter, 5th-level spells	Celebrimbor is lost to Sauron. Dying, Talion takes up Isildur's ring to keep fighting (page 6).

Levels 1–5 are backstory the games only sketch. The order of events in *Shadow of War* is approximate.

SHADOW OF MORDOR & WAR → 5E

IN THE GAME	ON THIS SHEET
Bound to Celebrimbor's wraith	His Ranger subclass, Wraith-Bound (page 2)
Two souls in one body	Celebrimbor's Strike: a third attack each Attack action
Hit streak and Might	The Might bar: six boxes, +1 a hit or counter, −1 when he's hit
Execution, Wraith Flash, Drain, Brutalize, Elven Rage	Might techniques (page 2)
Dying and coming back	Banished from Death: back at nightfall
Last Chance	A Con save at 0 HP, harder each time
The wraith world	Bonus Action sight; Advantage on Perception and Survival
Elf-shot and Focus	Azkâr: 8 shots a rest, Advantage when he holds still
Shadow Strike and its chains	A Bonus Action teleport strike; Steel Wind Strike
Brand, Dominate, bodyguards	Brand (orcs and beasts), the New Ring
Riding caragors, graugs, drakes	Shadow Mount, Dominate Beast, Mounted Combatant
Counter, vault, stun	Freeflow Counter, Riposte, Evasive Footwork, a Shove
Stealth kills, drops from above	Stealth +17; Acharn's critical hits; Nature's Veil
Climbing towers, huge leaps	Roving, Jump
The Nemesis system	Promotions when he dies; known weaknesses give Advantage
Runes and gems	The +2 on each weapon
Celebrimbor's memories and artifacts	Locate Object; Two Minds
Gear sets, followers' traits, sieges	Not modeled

WHO HE IS

Talion was a Ranger of Gondor, posted with his wife Ioreth and their son Dirhael at the Black Gate, where Gondor kept watch on an empty Mordor. When Sauron came back, three of his Black Captains, the Hammer, the Tower and the Black Hand, took the Gate and killed all three of them in a ritual. It was meant to call back an elven wraith: Celebrimbor, the smith who forged the Rings of Power with Sauron's help and lost everything to him. The wraith bound itself to Talion, and Talion was banished from death.

In *Shadow of Mordor* the two hunt the Black Captains across Udûn and Nurn. Celebrimbor's memories come back piece by piece, and with them the power to brand orcs. Talion turns Sauron's own army against its masters, kills all three Black Captains, and ends the game resolved to forge a new ring.

In *Shadow of War* Celebrimbor forges it, and they build an army of branded orcs to take Mordor's fortresses. Minas Ithil falls to the Nazgûl; Talion fights the Nine and a Balrog. Celebrimbor's ambition grows until he means to be a new Dark Lord, and in the end he's lost to Sauron. Dying, Talion takes a Nazgûl's ring to keep fighting.

LEGENDARY FEATS

- **Killed all three Black Captains**: the Hammer, the Tower and the Black Hand of Sauron.
- **Branded Mordor's warchiefs** and turned Sauron's own army on him.
- **Died again and again**, and came back every time.
- **Rode caragors and graugs**, and later drakes.
- **Faced a Balrog** and lived.
- **Defeated the Nazgûl who had been Isildur.**
- **Took Mordor's fortresses** one by one with an army of orcs.
- **Held them for years** against Sauron, even as a Ringwraith.

PERSONALITY

Traits: Grim, steady and patient, with a soldier's discipline and a dry edge. He protects the slaves of Nurn and anyone else Mordor grinds down.

Ideal: Revenge at first; then stopping Sauron, whatever it costs.

Bonds: Ioreth and Dirhael, dead at the Gate. Celebrimbor, the uneasy partner in his head.

Flaw: He'll use anything, even a cursed ring, to keep the fight going.

APPEARANCE

A Gondorian man in his prime: dark hair worn long, a short beard, a lean, hard build. The games give no height or age.

Ranger's leathers, bracers and a hooded cloak; sword at his hip, bow on his back.

When the wraith acts, Celebrimbor's pale, glowing form flickers over him, and his branding hand burns with light.

The latest version. *Shadow of War* (2017) is his last game. After Act 3 he wears Isildur's ring. In Act 4, the Shadow Wars, he holds Mordor's fortresses for decades, but the ring wins in the end: Talion becomes a Nazgûl. The true ending shows his spirit freed when the One Ring is destroyed. Troy Baker voices Talion; Alastair Duncan voices Celebrimbor. Warner Bros. closed Monolith, the studio behind both games, in February 2025, and no new Talion game had been announced as of mid-2026. **To play Talion the Nazgûl** HB: Celebrimbor is gone (no Might, Brand or wraith world). Isildur's ring holds him instead: he still can't die for good, he can't be Frightened, and as a Bonus Action foes within 30 ft make a DC 16 Wis save or are Frightened of him for 1 minute.

THE PEOPLE IN HIS LIFE

Ioreth and Dirhael, his wife and son, killed with him in the ritual.

Celebrimbor, the wraith in his head: partner, teacher, and at last a would-be Dark Lord.

Gollum, who knows the wraith, and helps for his own reasons.

Ratbag, a cowardly orc Talion pushes up the ranks.

Queen Marwen and Lithariel of Nurn, and **Torvin**, a dwarf hunter.

Shelob, who wears a woman's shape and trades in visions.

Eltariel, Galadriel's blade, who hunts the Nine.

The Black Hand of Sauron, who killed his family, and Sauron himself.

BUILD NOTES

Ranger (Wraith-Bound) 17 / Fighter (Battle Master) 3. He's a Ranger of Gondor, so the Ranger is the base. The four subclass levels follow the games: the ritual, the brand, the New Ring, Elven Rage. Three Battle Master levels are the freeflow: counters, vaults, Action Surge.

Ability scores: 27-point buy (Str 12, Dex 15, Con 14, Int 10, Wis 13, Cha 8), then the background, Resilient (Con), two ASIs and Mounted Combatant.

Power note: about 50 damage a round with Hunter's Mark (three hits of about 17). An Elven Rage turn is three Executions of about 52 each, about 150. Counters keep him unhit, and he can't stay dead.

WHAT 5E CAN'T COPY

- The Nemesis system: endless orc captains, each with a name and a grudge.
- Freeflow at full speed: a dozen orcs countered in seconds.
- Two voices in one head.

Version: *Middle-earth: Shadow of War* (Monolith, 2017), Act 3, with *Shadow of Mordor* (2014). Written from knowledge of the games, without new research. Least certain: the order of events in *War*, the details of the Balrog and Isildur fights, how long the Shadow Wars last, and anything after mid-2026. The games depart from Tolkien's books in places (Celebrimbor's story, Shelob's human shape). This is v2: Freeflow Counter, Celebrimbor's Strike, the stronger Execution and Resilient came from arena testing.